



Race heats up: While Hardik Pandya is likely to be the frontrunner for the seam-bowling all-rounder's spot, Shivam Dube has given compelling reasons for selectors and the team management to consider him for the T20 World Cup. R. V. MOORTHY & AP

demanding, stability is the key. While the former selectors believe that India's core team looks solid, the majority is in favour of picking Pandya as a middle-order batter and a fourth fast-bowling option, despite him being at the receiving end of the Mumbai Indians fans.

"International cricket is a different ball game altogether," says Surendra Bhave, one of the selectors who picked India's ODI World Cup-winning team in 2011.

Bhave believes that tournaments like the T20 World Cup deserve that sincerity, and it's essential to go with seniority rather than experimentation.

"Let's be honest. There's a huge difference between the IPL and international cricket, and we need to keep that in mind when picking a

team," Bhave says. While he firmly believes that there's no alternative to big-match temperament — Virat and Rohit bring that to the table — Bhave hopes to see Shivam Dube and his ward Ruturaj Gaikwad in the ranks. Dube has been in excellent form since India's T20 series against Afghanistan, while Ruturaj has made his presence felt for both the Indian team and Chennai Super Kings.

"Dube moved up quite a bit last year, and the selectors should look at him," Bhave says, adding, "Ruturaj, on the other hand, operates at a sublime level.

If you have to get cracking against quality bowling, he is an exceptional player and looks solid against any bowling."

But will there be enough space to fit all the 'deserving' candidates?

'SPORTSTAR'S 15

1. Rohit Sharma (Capt)
2. Yashasvi Jaiswal
3. Virat Kohli
4. Suryakumar Yadav
5. Rishabh Pant
6. Hardik Pandya
7. Ravindra Jadeja
8. Jasprit Bumrah
9. Kuldeep Yadav
10. Mohammed Siraj
11. Arshdeep Singh
12. Rinku Singh
13. Sanju Samson
14. Axar Patel
15. Harshal Patel